

Saturday, 4 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

27° 16°

BIRMINGHAM

Drizzle

23° 15°

MANCHESTER

Light drizzle

20° 16°

GLASGOW

Light drizzle

16° 14°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 The UK government is in talks with Pakistan about deporting a convicted grooming gang leader.
The Prime Minister's spokesperson confirmed they are exploring 'all possible options' to remove the individual from the UK. It follows public outcry over the case.
CRIME · UK

2 A mother says new custodial sentences for her daughter's rapists are 'better' but still 'not enough'.
Two teenage boys, initially given non-custodial sentences, have now been handed four-year detention terms. The mother continues to campaign for stronger penalties.
JUSTICE · UK

3 A man has been jailed for 35 years for shooting dead a boy in a park play area.
Aderahman Boumzough was convicted of murdering Rene Graham and also for attempted murder. The tragic incident shocked the local community.
CRIME · UK

4 Millions of people in the UK may have unknowingly eaten 'lamb' kebabs made with goat, skin and fat.
An investigation found that some kebabs contained 'less than 10% sheep' meat. This raises serious concerns about food labelling and consumer trust.
FOOD · UK

5 A rapist police officer was accused of an earlier attack, but the case was dropped.
Cameron Ross was able to continue working as an officer for six years after being cleared of a previous rape allegation. This has raised questions about police vetting procedures.
JUSTICE · UK

What's coming up

- 1 A London West End theatre is being renamed after acclaimed playwright Sir Tom Stoppard.**
The Duke of York's Theatre will now bear his name, honouring his incredible contribution to British theatre. It's a fantastic tribute to a living legend.
ON AIR – Have you seen any of Sir Tom Stoppard's plays? Which is your favourite?
THEATRE · LONDON
- 2 Tens of thousands of people are rushing for tickets to see the Bayeux Tapestry in the UK.**
The historic masterpiece will travel from France to be displayed on British soil for the very first first time. It's a truly unmissable event for history buffs.
ON AIR – Are you planning to go and see the Bayeux Tapestry? What's the most historic item you've ever seen?
EXHIBITION · COMING UP
- 3 All eyes are on what guests will wear to Taylor Swift's reported wedding to Travis Kelce in New York City.**
Speculation suggests a romantic, fairytale vibe could dominate the event. It's set to be one of the biggest celebrity weddings of the year!
ON AIR – If you were invited to Taylor Swift's wedding, what would you wear?
CELEBRITY · THIS WEEK
- 4 A new plaque has been unveiled to honour actors Timothy West and Prunella Scales, celebrating their 'Great Canal Journeys' TV show.**
Their son, Samuel West, described the programme as a 'love story' between his parents. It's a lovely tribute to a much-loved couple.
ON AIR – Did you ever watch 'Great Canal Journeys'? What's your favourite travel show?
TELEVISION · PAST
- 5 Cast members of a groundbreaking LGBT dating show are sharing its impact as the final season airs.**
The show has been praised for its pioneering representation and positive influence on viewers. It's a bittersweet moment for fans as it concludes.
ON AIR – What TV shows do you think have been truly groundbreaking in their representation?
TELEVISION · THIS WEEK

On the schedule

- 1 England's women's cricket team has beaten South Africa to reach the T20 World Cup final!**
 They recovered from an early loss of wickets to comfortably win by 40 runs at The Oval. They'll now face six-time champions Australia in the final at Lord's.
ON AIR – Will you be watching the Women's T20 World Cup final? Do you think England can beat Australia?
 CRICKET · UK
- 2 England have 'big concerns' ahead of their World Cup clash with Mexico – so, who would you pick?**
 Fans are debating who should play at right-back and if Anthony Gordon deserves to start. It's a crucial game and Gareth Southgate has some big decisions to make.
ON AIR – Who would be in your starting XI for England against Mexico? Any surprise choices?
 FOOTBALL · UK
- 3 British hopes at Wimbledon now rest solely on Arthur Fery, the French-born star.**
 He's become the only home player to reach the third round, carrying the weight of expectation. Can he continue his impressive run?
ON AIR – Are you following Wimbledon closely this year? Who are you backing to win?
 TENNIS · UK
- 4 Four-time Tour de France winner Chris Froome has announced his retirement from professional cycling.**
 The British star brings an end to an illustrious career, having dominated the sport for years. He'll be remembered as one of cycling's greats.
ON AIR – What's your favourite memory of Chris Froome's career? Do you follow cycling?
 CYCLING · PAST
- 5 Germany's football association is seeking talks with Jurgen Klopp about becoming their men's national team coach.**
 This comes after Julian Nagelsmann resigned from the role. Could Klopp be tempted back into management so soon?
ON AIR – Do you think Jurgen Klopp would be a good fit for the German national team? Or should he stay retired?
 FOOTBALL · EUROPE

Quick hits

- 1 A new study reveals that listening to the sound of 'babbling brooks' can significantly reduce stress.**
Researchers found that the natural, gentle flow of water has a calming effect on our minds, helping to lower anxiety levels and promote relaxation. So, next time you're feeling a bit overwhelmed, perhaps a trip to a local stream is in order!
- 2 The trend of 'upcycling old furniture' into stylish new pieces is booming across the UK.**
People are getting creative with paint, fabric, and a bit of elbow grease, transforming forgotten chests of drawers and tired tables into unique home decor. It's a wonderful way to be sustainable and add character to your home.
- 3 Scientists have discovered that 'plants can communicate' with each other through an underground fungal network.**
It's like a secret internet for flora! They can share nutrients and even send warning signals about pests or diseases to their leafy neighbours. Nature truly is full of surprises.
- 4 A quirky new poll suggests that over half of Britons admit to 'talking to their houseplants'.**
Whether it's offering encouragement to a wilting fern or congratulating a blooming orchid, many of us treat our greenery like a silent confidant. And who knows, maybe they listen!
- 5 The nostalgic appeal of 'classic board games' is seeing a major revival among families and friends.**
From Monopoly to Scrabble, people are rediscovering the simple joy of unplugging and spending quality time together around a table. It's a fantastic way to create lasting memories without screens.
- 6 Research indicates that 'taking a short, brisk walk' in nature can boost your creativity by up to 60%.**
Stepping away from your desk and immersing yourself in greenery allows your mind to wander and connect ideas in new ways. A bit of fresh air could be the perfect muse!
- 7 The surprising joy of 'homemade bread making' continues to rise in popularity.**
Many are finding satisfaction in the simple process of kneading dough and the incredible aroma of freshly baked bread filling the kitchen. It's a wonderfully comforting and rewarding pastime.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'rearranging' what in a shop, even if we know it's a bit naughty?

ANSWER: THE TINNED GOODS ON THE SUPERMARKET SHELF TO MAKE THEM LOOK TIDIER!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'lucky pen' that they absolutely have to use for important paperwork. What's special about it?

ANSWER: IT WRITES PERFECTLY EVERY TIME AND HAS NEVER LET THEM DOWN DURING A CROSSWORD!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you rediscover an 'old family photo album' and it sparks so many wonderful memories?

Which picture always makes you smile, and what's the story behind it?

- We all have those 'little tricks' we use to make a cup of tea or coffee absolutely perfect, don't we?

What's your secret ingredient or method that makes your brew just right?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of owls is called a 'parliament'.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Penguins are the only birds that can't fly, but they can run faster than any other bird.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The Great Barrier Reef is the largest living structure on Earth, visible from outer space.
- The Eiffel Tower can be 15 cm taller during the summer due to the expansion of the iron.
- Bumblebee bats are the smallest mammals in the world, weighing less than a penny.
- The 'tear-drop' shape of a raindrop only occurs when it falls; otherwise, they are spherical.
- A bolt of lightning is five times hotter than the surface of the sun.
- Some species of jellyfish are biologically immortal, meaning they can revert to an earlier stage of life and restart their growth.
- The King James Bible is the most published book in history, with over 5 billion copies printed.
- There are more possible permutations of a standard deck of 52 cards than there are atoms on Earth.

On this day

Day 185 of the year, 180 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Antoine Daniel; Christian feast day: Andrew of Crete; Christian feast day: Bertha of Artois; Christian feast day: Blessed Catherine Jarrige. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1931 — Stephen Boyd, Northern Ireland-born American actor (died 1977)
- 1966 — Lee Reherman, American actor (died 2016)
- 1943 — Alan Wilson, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 1970)
- 1966 — Ronni Ancona, Scottish actress and screenwriter
- 1918 — Alec Bedser, English cricketer (died 2010)
- 1965 — Gérard Watkins, English actor and playwright
- 1938 — Bill Withers, American singer-songwriter and producer (died 2020)
- 1952 — John Waite, English singer-songwriter and guitarist

THE DAY TODAY

- 1994 — Rwandan genocide: Kigali, the Rwandan capital, is captured by the Rwandan Patriotic Front, ending the genocide in the city.
- 2001 — Vladivostok Air Flight 352 crashes on approach to Irkutsk Airport killing all 145 people on board.
- 2024 — The Labour Party, led by Keir Starmer, wins a landslide majority in the 2024 United Kingdom general election, ending 14 years of Conservative government.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1054 — A supernova, called SN 1054, is seen by Chinese Song dynasty, Arab, and possibly Amerindian observers near the star Zeta Tauri. For several months it remains bright enough to be seen during the day. Its remnants form the Crab Nebula.
- 2009 — The first of four days of bombings begins on the southern Philippine island group of Mindanao.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1998 — Japan launches the Nozomi probe to Mars, joining the United States and Russia as a space exploring nation.

2009 — The Statue of Liberty's crown reopens to the public after eight years of closure due to security concerns following the September 11 attacks.

- 2004 — The cornerstone of the Freedom Tower is laid on the World Trade Center site in New York City.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 186 of the year, 179 days left in 2026. Today Bloody Thursday (International Longshore and Warehouse Union); Christian feast day: Anthony Maria Zaccaria, priest (died 1539); Christian feast day: Cyril and Methodius (a public holiday in Czech Republic and Slovakia); Christian feast day: Martha, mother of Simeon Stylites the Younger. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1929 — Tony Lock, English cricketer (died 1995)
- 1991 — Jason Dolley, American actor, musician and Twitch streamer
- 1982 — Dave Haywood, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1969 — RZA, American rapper, producer, actor, and director
- 1916 — Ivor Powell, Welsh footballer (died 2012)
- 1949 — Jill Murphy, British children's author (died 2021)
- 1954 — Jimmy Crespo, American guitarist and songwriter
- 1979 — Shane Filan, Irish singer-songwriter

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1994 — Jeff Bezos founds Amazon.
- 1975 — Cape Verde gains its independence from Portugal.
- 2012 — The Shard in London is inaugurated as the tallest building in Europe, with a height of 310 metres (1,020 ft).

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2009 — The largest hoard of Anglo-Saxon gold ever discovered in Britain, consisting of more than 1,500 items, is found near the village of Hammerwich, near Lichfield, Staffordshire.
- 1971 — The Twenty-sixth Amendment to the United States Constitution, lowering the voting age from 21 to 18 years, is formally certified by President Richard Nixon.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026		AUGUST 2026	
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn	FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off	FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU	FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day	FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW			
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites		
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot		
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2		
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)		
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW			
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller		
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)		

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)